

Exercise 4: Develop an end-of-life (EOL) plan for the scenario

Part I: Review the EOL planning format

EOL planning category	Planning considerations
Product identification	• The product or product line name is documented • Documentation includes Product ID/SKU information and so on • The impact on the Product Mix is understood
Rationale	• The rationale for product retirement is defined • Retirement process is defined
Retirement strategy	• Retirement strategy is defined • Options to include divest, spin-off, harvest, or retirement are justified
Proposed mitigation plan	• The retirement process is mapped • The process is shared and understood
Communications planning	• Define how the retirement process will be communicated
Internal impact	• Manufacturing and operations considerations are addressed • Customer support considerations are addressed • Sales and support considerations are addressed • Human Resource and legal considerations are addressed • Legal and regulatory considerations are addressed
External impact	• External customer and partner support considerations are addressed • Customer support considerations are addressed
Cost analysis	• Cost/Benefit analysis is performed • Define approval process
Scheduling	• Retirement activity schedules are developed • Schedules are realistic and achievable
Risk analysis	• Risks are identified and qualified • Contingency responses are developed
Critical success factors (CSF)	• CSF are identified • A CSF measurement plan is developed

Part II: End-of-life (EOL) plan blank template

EOL planning category	Planning considerations
Product identification	Mobile WB-3000 is clearly identified with its product line. Documentation includes product specifications and its role within the company's whiteboard product mix.
Rationale	Product will be retired after 2 years due to planned obsolescence and advancing technology. New and improved versions will replace it.
Retirement strategy	A spin-off strategy will be used to develop an upgraded version based on existing technology. Gradual phase-out over 1 year.
Proposed mitigation plan	Customers will be transitioned to the new version with incentives. All warranties and contracts will be honored. Replacement process is clearly defined.
Communications planning	Customers will be notified 6 months before retirement. Communication through email, website, and sales channels. Internal teams will also be informed.
Internal impact	Manufacturing will reduce production gradually. Customer support will handle transition issues. Sales teams will promote the new product. HR and legal teams will manage staffing and contracts.
External impact	Customers will be supported during transition. Partners (retailers, distributors) will be informed and aligned. Customer satisfaction will be maintained.
Cost analysis	Cost/benefit analysis shows it is not profitable to maintain beyond 3 years. Leadership approval is obtained for EOL plan
Scheduling	Product replacement communication at 18 months post-launch. Full retirement at 24 months. Phase-out over 1 year is planned and achievable
Risk analysis	Risks include customer dissatisfaction, low adoption of new product, and supply chain issues. Mitigation includes incentives, communication, and support.
Critical success factors (CSF)	Successful customer transition to new product, high satisfaction, minimal returns, and strong adoption of the upgraded version.